

2. For example, the increase in the cost of renting an apartment.
To live and work for at least a year in a foreign country.

PROBLEM Neither sentence has a verb.

TO CORRECT Rewrite each sentence so that it has a verb.

For example, the increase in the cost of renting an apartment **is** one reason for more people being homeless.

To live and work for at least a year in a foreign country **has** always **been** my dream.

3. Teachers who give too much homework.

PROBLEM This is a noun (*teachers*) + an adjective clause (*who give too much homework*). The noun is the beginning of an independent clause that was never finished.

TO CORRECT Finish the independent clause.

Teachers who give too much homework **are unpopular**.

Always check your own writing for sentence fragments. Pay particular attention to sentences beginning with subordinators (*although, since, because, if, before, and so on*). These are DANGER WORDS! Make sure that every clause beginning with these words is attached to an independent clause.

PRACTICE 2

Rewriting Sentence Fragments

- A. Read the following sentences. Mark them *Frag.* if they are sentence fragments, or *Comp.* if they are complete sentences. On a separate sheet of paper, rewrite each fragment to make a complete sentence.

- _____ 1. The desire of all humankind to live in peace and freedom, for example.
- _____ 2. Second, a fact that men are physically stronger than women.
- _____ 3. The best movie I saw last year.
- _____ 4. *Titanic* was the most financially successful movie ever made, worldwide.
- _____ 5. For example, many students have part-time jobs.
- _____ 6. Although people want to believe that all men are created equal.
- _____ 7. Finding a suitable marriage partner is a challenging task.
- _____ 8. Many of my friends who did not have the opportunity to go to college.
- _____ 9. Working during the morning and attending classes during the afternoon.
- _____ 10. Because I do not feel that grades in college have any value.
- _____ 11. A tsunami that occurred in the Indian Ocean in December 2004, killing more than 200,000 people.
- _____ 12. The total energy of the tsunami waves was about five megatons of TNT.
- _____ 13. More than twice the total explosive energy used during all of World War II, including two atomic bombs, according to one expert.

- _____ 14. Evidence that the wave reached a height of 80 feet (24 meters) when coming ashore along the coastline and rose to 100 feet (30 meters) in some areas when traveling inland.
- _____ 15. Despite a lag of up to several hours between the earthquake and tsunami, nearly all of the victims were taken completely by surprise.

B. Read the following short essay. Put brackets [] around any sentence fragments you find and mark them *Frag*. Then correct the fragments on a separate sheet of paper.

Women Drivers

- 1 Sexism¹ extends even into the area of automobile driving, it seems. Believing that they are far better drivers than women. Men consider women drivers incompetent, inattentive, and even dangerous behind the wheel.
- 2 However, statistics prove that women are, in fact, safer drivers than men. For example, insurance rates. Insurance rates for women are 20 percent lower than they are for men. Another proof is that more accidents are caused by male drivers between the ages of 18 and 25 than by any other group. Also, the greater percentage of accidents involving deaths caused by men. Although women are criticized for being too cautious. They are really just being safe drivers.
- 3 The reasons for women drivers' safer driving habits can perhaps be found in the differing attitudes of the sexes toward automobiles. On the one hand, women drivers who regard the automobile as a convenience. Like a washing machine. On the other hand, men regard the automobile as an extension of their egos. Using it as a weapon when they feel particularly aggressive. Or using it as a status symbol.
- 4 All in all, women are safer drivers. Because of their attitude. Men can learn to become safe drivers. If they adopt the attitude that an automobile is merely a convenience.

Choppy Sentences

Choppy sentences are sentences that are too short. Short sentences can be effective in certain situations. For instance, when you want to make an impact, use a short sentence.

Despite countless doctors' warnings, news stories, and magazine articles about the importance of eating a nutritious, balanced diet, many people resist developing healthy eating habits. Some people just like junk food.

(A sentence of 25 words is followed by one of 6 words. The second sentence has greater impact because it is so short.)

¹Sexism: men's belief in male superiority

PRACTICE 4**Run-On/Comma
Splice Sentences**

A. Correct the following run-on/comma splice sentences using the method indicated.

1. A newly arrived international student faces several challenges, for example, he or she has to cope with a new culture.
 - a. Add a period: _____
 - b. Add a semicolon: _____
2. New York City is very cosmopolitan, people from many cultures and ethnic groups live there.
 - a. Add a period: _____
 - b. Add a semicolon: _____
 - c. Add a subordinator: _____
 - d. Add a coordinator: _____
3. Learning a new language is like learning to swim it takes a lot of practice.
Add a coordinator: _____
4. Ask for assistance at the reference desk in the library, a librarian is always on duty.
Add a semicolon: _____
5. Skiing is a dangerous sport you can easily break your leg or your neck.
Add a subordinator: _____

B. Some of the following sentences are run-ons or comma splices, and some are correct. Check each sentence. If it is incorrect, write *RO* or *CS* in the space at the left. If it is correct, leave the space blank. Then, on a separate sheet of paper, correct the incorrect sentences.

- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| _____ <i>RO</i> | 1. Two letters arrived on Monday a third one came on Wednesday.
<u>Two letters arrived on Monday; a third one came on Wednesday.</u> |
| _____ | 2. An encyclopedia is a valuable source of information it contains summaries of every area of knowledge. |
| _____ | 3. Because of the rapid expansion of human knowledge, it is difficult to keep encyclopedias current. |
| _____ | 4. A printed encyclopedia becomes out of date almost as soon as it is published also it is quite expensive to purchase. |
| _____ | 5. Online encyclopedias are available to everyone with access to the Internet. |

- _____ 6. Articles in encyclopedias are written by experts in each subject, who are often university professors.
 - _____ 7. An editor of an encyclopedia does not write articles he only collects and edits articles written by subject experts.
 - _____ 8. To find a book on a certain subject, you used to look in a card catalog, to find a magazine article on a subject, you used to look in a periodical index.
 - _____ 9. Now, most libraries have thrown away their card catalogs, they have computerized catalogs that are much more efficient to use and update.
 - _____ 10. Many periodical indexes, which list only titles of magazine articles and indicate where to find them, have been replaced by computer indexes, some of which display abstracts¹ and even entire articles instantly.
 - _____ 11. If you cannot find any information on a subject, you can always ask a librarian to help you, they are paid to assist students.
- C. Locate the run-on/comma splice sentences in the following paragraphs. Mark them by writing *RO* or *CS* above them. Then, on a separate sheet of paper, rewrite both paragraphs, correcting the mistakes that you found. There are four errors.

¹Teachers at Stone Mountain State College give higher grades than teachers at 12 of the 19 other colleges in the state college system, according to a recent report from the State Institutional Research Committee. ²This report showed that more than one-third of the undergraduate grades awarded in the spring semester 2005 were A's only 1.1 percent were F's. ³The percentage of A's awarded to graduate students was even higher, almost two-thirds were A's.

⁴While students may be happy to receive high grades, evidence suggests that this trend is having negative consequences. ⁵Investigation of the admissions criteria² of some graduate and professional schools indicates that the admissions offices of these schools are discounting high grades on the transcripts of SMSC students, this means that an A from SMSC is not equal to an A from other universities. ⁶Grade inflation may, therefore, hurt a student from Stone Mountain State College who intends to apply to a graduate or professional school he or she may not be accepted despite a high grade point average.

Stringy Sentences

A **stringy sentence** is a sentence with too many clauses, usually connected with *and*, *but*, *so*, and sometimes *because*. It often results from writing the way you speak, going on and on like a string without an end.

To correct a stringy sentence, divide it and/or recombine the clauses, remembering to subordinate when appropriate.

¹**abstracts:** summaries

²**criteria:** standards by which a judgment is made